

THE HEART OF ETHER

Once there was a prince known as Ether, son of the High God of the Underworld. As he roamed the Overworld, he fell in love with a human woman who knew not what he was, but who loved him for who he was. He ruled the dark, but she was all the light he ever needed. After years of passion and devotion, tragedy robbed the woman of her health, and as punishment for falling for a human, the God of Death condemned his son's beloved to the Underworld. Pressing his lips to hers one last time, the dark prince offered her his heart, in the form of a black flame, promising her this:

"Although it may not illuminate a path in the shadows, as the brightness of your affection has shone for me, I hope, my darling, that the warmth of this flame will remind you of my embrace

through darkness and light. I will wait for you, and be forever yours". The black flame saved the woman, but alas stripped away the prince's immortality, damning him to roam the Abyss alone, yearning for the happiness that was taken from him. The woman scoured for decades to find a way to be with her fated. Her need to reach him wove itself into the magic of the flames, their will expressing hers. At the cost of her life, the woman's powers tore Ether out of the Abyss, reuniting the loved ones in the warmth of the Flow of Souls.